Microsoft Purview for Education

Implementation Solution Guide

Version 1.0.0 · 2026-07-07

Contents

Executive Summary — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 5

What you get . . . 5

What this delivers . . . 5

The deployment model . . . 6

An honest note . . . 6

Outcome . . . 6

1. Solution Overview — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 6

What this solution is . . . 6

Why "tailored to education" matters . . . 7

The four capabilities, education-fit . . . 7

How it works in Microsoft Purview . . . 7

What is authored exactly vs deferred . . . 8

Benefits . . . 8

Limitations (be honest with buyers) . . . 8

The standard deployment model . . . 9

2. Requirements Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 9

2.1 Compliance licensing sufficient for the education capabilities (category G1) . . . 9

2.2 Least-privilege Purview roles for the education operators (category G2) . . . 10

2.3 In-scope education workloads and the education-record data map (category G4) . . . 10

2.4 A custom sensitive information type for the institution's student ID . . . 10

2.5 The education sensitivity-label taxonomy is agreed . . . 10

2.6 DLP simulation/Test mode available and to be used first (category G6) . . . 11

2.7 Records schedule + retention determinations from the records/legal function (category G5) . . . 11

2.8 Audit (Standard/Premium) enabled for evidence . . . 11

2.9 Compliance Manager access + an education assessment template . . . 11

2.10 Pilot scope + change control for enforcing changes (category G6) . . . 11

Checklist . . . 12

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions 12

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing . . . 12

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access . . . 13

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain . . . 13

4. Data sources & scope in scope . . . 13

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders . . . 13

6. A pilot scope and change control . . . 14

3. Implementation Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 14

Phase 1 — Assess and prepare (no changes) . . . 15
Phase 2 — Classification foundation (labels + SIT) . . . 15
Phase 3 — DLP in Test/simulation . . . 16
Phase 4 — Retention & records (schedule-driven) . . . 17
Phase 5 — Posture, validate, and expand . . . 17
5. Testing Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 18
Test 1 — Compliance licensing + roles are sufficient . . . 18
Test 2 — The education label taxonomy exists and is published to the pilot . . . 18
Test 3 — Applying the Student Record label protects the file . . . 19
Test 4 — The `EDU - Student ID` SIT matches education-record content . . . 19
Test 5 — DLP is in Test mode with the education-record conditions . . . 19
Test 6 — DLP catches a simulated education-record leak (in Test, blocks no one) . . . 19
Test 7 — Auto-labeling simulation is accurate (if configured) . . . 19
Test 8 — Retention label exists with the approved period and is published . . . 19
Test 9 — Audit is logging label/DLP/retention activity . . . 20
Test 10 — Compliance Manager posture is scored with evidence . . . 20
Pass/fail gate . . . 20
6. Troubleshooting Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 20
A. Licensing & roles . . . 20
B. Sensitivity labels . . . 21
C. Sensitive information type (student ID) . . . 21
D. Data Loss Prevention . . . 21
E. Auto-labeling . . . 22
F. Retention & records . . . 22
G. Audit & evidence . . . 22
Escalation checklist . . . 23
7. Best Practices — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 23
Design . . . 23
Pilot in simulation/test — always . . . 23
Accuracy and friction . . . 24
Retention & records (handle with extra care) . . . 24
Evidence & posture . . . 24
Operations, automation & security . . . 24
8. Deliverables Summary — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA) 25
Documentation . . . 25
PowerShell scripts (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Microsoft Graph) . . . 26

What the buyer receives 26
Outcome 26
Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts 28

Executive Summary — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Schools, districts, colleges, and universities hold some of the most sensitive personal data there is — **student education records** protected under **FERPA** (the U.S. Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act), plus staff PII, health and counseling notes, financial-aid data, and research. A generic, out-of-the-box Purview configuration does not reflect an education institution's specific data-protection obligations: it leaves a **compliance gap** and a **data-risk exposure**. The fix is a Purview program **tailored to education** — sensitivity labels, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), retention/records, and compliance posture aligned to **FERPA** and the way education data actually flows.

This solution delivers that end to end in **Microsoft Purview**: an education-tailored label taxonomy, FERPA-oriented DLP, a student-record retention approach, and a Compliance Manager posture — **configured, piloted in simulation/test where the capability supports it, validated against pass/fail gates, and made operable**. It is an **industry bundle**: it composes the institution's program and references the granular Purview capability products (label taxonomy, DLP packs, retention/records, Compliance Manager) so the pieces fit together for an education tenant rather than being wired up in isolation.

What you get

• A plain-language **Solution Overview** of the education-tailored Purview program and the

Assess → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)** model.

• A **Requirements Guide** with **verify / implement-if-missing** for every prerequisite —

compliance licensing (E5 / E5 Compliance where features require it), least-privilege Purview roles, in-scope education workloads and data, and the compliance/records/privacy/legal stakeholders. The six category-wide Purview requirements are **referenced, not repeated**.

• An **Implementation Guide** of precise, ordered **Purview portal + Security & Compliance PowerShell

+ Graph **steps: publish the education label set, stand up FERPA-oriented DLP in** Test/simulation**, configure student-record retention, and set the Compliance Manager posture — each label/policy/object** named**,** piloted in simulation first**, with pass/fail gates and rollback.

• **Five PowerShell scripts** — Discovery, Configuration/Remediation (simulation / `-WhatIf` first),

Validation, Reporting, and a scope/health helper — via **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`) and/or **Microsoft Graph**, read-only or `-WhatIf` by default, **no credentials in code**.

• **Testing** and **Troubleshooting** guides and a **Best Practices** section for a confident rollout.

What this delivers

An education institution whose Purview program **fits FERPA and the education data estate** — student records labeled and protected, DLP catching education-record leaks (proven in simulation before it blocks anyone), retention aligned to the records schedule, and a defensible, evidenced compliance posture.

The deployment model

Assess → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate/test)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)** — build the labels, DLP, and retention; prove them in simulation/test on a pilot scope; validate against pass/fail gates; then enforce and expand in waves.

An honest note

Microsoft Purview capabilities are **heavily licensing-/plan-dependent** (many require **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on; some are in preview) and the portal is **actively evolving** — this package **cites Microsoft's public documentation or flags "verify your licensing/tenant"** rather than asserting availability or inventing portal paths. **Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations** — FERPA applicability, the records schedule, retention periods, legal holds — are **deferred to the institution's compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions**. This solution provides the technical configuration method and the evidence, **not** the determination. High-impact policies (DLP, labels, retention) are always **piloted in simulation/test first**.

Outcome

A Microsoft Purview program **tailored to education and aligned to FERPA** — configured, piloted, validated, and defensible — so the capability is in place and evidenced, not left as a generic default.

1. Solution Overview — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

What this solution is

This solution stands up a **Microsoft Purview program tailored to education** — one aligned to the way schools, districts, and higher-education institutions handle **student education records** under **FERPA**, plus the staff PII, health/counseling, financial-aid, and research data that live alongside them. Instead of a generic, one-size-fits-all Purview setup, it configures the four core information- protection and governance capabilities — **sensitivity labels, Data Loss Prevention (DLP), data-lifecycle/retention & records, and the Compliance Manager posture** — with an **education-fit taxonomy and rule set**, piloted in **simulation/test** before anything enforces.

It is an **industry bundle**. Rather than treating each capability as an isolated project, it composes the institution's end-to-end program and **references the granular Purview capability products** — the sensitivity-label taxonomy, the FERPA/DLP pack, retention & records management, and Compliance Manager — so the pieces are designed to **fit an education tenant together**: labels feed DLP and retention; DLP protects the labeled student-record data; retention satisfies the records schedule; Compliance Manager scores the whole posture.

It is authored for a Microsoft 365 administrator or compliance operator with no prior Purview deep-dive experience: exact **Purview portal** navigation and **Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph** automation, with every label, policy, and object named.

Why "tailored to education" matters

FERPA governs **education records** — records directly related to a student and maintained by the institution (or a party acting for it). Purview has no single built-in "FERPA" switch: protecting education records well means **deciding what an education record is in your tenant**, **classifying it** (labels + sensitive information types), **preventing its inappropriate sharing** (DLP), **retaining and disposing of it per the records schedule** (retention/records), and **evidencing the whole thing** (Compliance Manager + audit). A generic label set and default DLP templates do none of this in education terms — hence an education-tailored program.

> ***What is *not* in this package (deferred to governance).*** *Whether FERPA applies to a given record, the **retention period** for student records, when a **legal hold** is placed, and the institution's **records file plan** are **compliance/records/privacy/legal determinations** — not technical defaults. This solution provides the **method and the evidence**; the institution's governance functions provide the **determination**. Label names, retention periods, and DLP thresholds shown here are **illustrative placeholders** to be confirmed with those owners.*

The four capabilities, education-fit

• **Sensitivity labels (education taxonomy).** A small, human-readable label set — e.g.

`EDU - Public`, `EDU - Internal`, `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`, `EDU - Highly Confidential` — published to staff (and, where appropriate, students) so education records can be marked and protected (encryption/marking) consistently. Container labels can protect Teams/SharePoint sites used for student data. (References the label-taxonomy granular product.)

• **Data Loss Prevention (FERPA-oriented).** DLP policies that detect **education-record** content

(student identifiers + names, and the sensitive information types the institution defines) across **Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, and endpoints**, and restrict inappropriate sharing — **started in Test/simulation mode** so you see what *would* be caught before it blocks anyone. (References the FERPA/DLP-pack granular product.)

• **Retention & records (student records).** Retention labels and policies that keep and then dispose

of student education records per the institution's **records schedule**, with disposition review where records management requires it. The **schedule and periods are the records function's determination**; Purview enforces them. (References the retention & records granular product.)

• **Compliance posture (Compliance Manager).** A Compliance Manager assessment (e.g. a **FERPA / data-

protection **template where your licensing includes premium assessments) that scores improvement actions and produces evidence — turning the program into a** defensible, measured** posture. (References the Compliance Manager granular product.)

How it works in Microsoft Purview

• Everything is configured in the **Microsoft Purview portal** (`purview.microsoft.com`) and, where the

M365 admin center governs licensing/roles, there. **Automation** is **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`, via the ExchangeOnlineManagement module) and **Microsoft Graph**.

• **Sensitivity labels** are created and **published** via label policies to a **pilot scope**; **DLP**

policies are created in **Test mode / simulation** and only later set to enforce; **retention** is applied via retention labels/policies (and label policies to publish them); **Compliance Manager** runs an assessment and tracks improvement actions.

• **Simulation/test first is mandatory.** Auto-labeling supports **simulation**; DLP supports **Test (with or without notifications) **before** Enforce**. High-impact changes are never turned straight on — they run in simulation/test on a pilot scope, are validated, then expanded to enforce.

What is authored exactly vs deferred

• **Exact navigation and cmdlets are given** for the **Purview portal**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell**, and** Graph** — from Microsoft's public documentation.

• **Licensing/plan dependence is flagged throughout.** Advanced DLP, auto-labeling with simulation, premium Compliance Manager assessments, and records management generally require **E5 / E5 Compliance** — where a capability is plan-gated or in preview, this package says **"verify your licensing/tenant"** rather than asserting it.

• **Regulatory/records/legal determinations are deferred** — FERPA applicability, retention periods, file plans, and legal holds are the institution's governance calls.

• **Sensitive information types for education records are institution-specific.** There is no universal built-in "FERPA" SIT; education-record detection is typically a **combination** of built-in SITs (names, U.S. SSN, etc.) plus a **custom SIT** for the institution's **student ID** format — confirm and build these with your data owners.

Benefits

• **Fits FERPA and the education estate** — labels, DLP, and retention designed for student records, not a generic default.

• **Safe by construction** — DLP and auto-labeling run in **simulation/test** on a pilot before they ever block or relabel.

• **Composed, not piecemeal** — an industry bundle that makes the granular capabilities fit together.

• **Defensible** — Compliance Manager + audit produce the evidence that the program exists and works.

• **Operable + reversible** — every policy is named, validated against pass/fail gates, and has a documented rollback.

Limitations (be honest with buyers)

• **Licensing-gated.** Several capabilities (advanced DLP, auto-labeling simulation, premium Compliance Manager assessments, records management) require **E5 / E5 Compliance** — **verify your licensing/tenant**; the package flags this at each step.

• **Determinations are not included.** FERPA applicability, retention periods, file plans, and legal

holds are **deferred** to compliance/records/privacy/legal — this is a technical implementation, not legal advice.

- **Education-record detection needs your inputs.** The custom student-ID SIT and the education-record

DLP conditions must be built from **your** identifiers and data — placeholders are provided to be confirmed.

- **The portal evolves.** Purview paths change; where a path is version-dependent the package flags

"verify against current Microsoft guidance / your tenant."

The standard deployment model

> ***Assess*** *the education data estate and obligations →* ***Design*** *the label/DLP/retention/posture →* ***Configure*** *the labels, DLP (Test), retention, and Compliance Manager →* ***Pilot in simulation/test*** *on a pilot scope →* ***Validate*** *against pass/fail gates →* ***Expand (enforce)*** *in waves. Pattern:* ***Assess*** *→* ***Design*** *→* ***Configure*** *→* ***Pilot (simulate)*** *→* ***Validate*** *→* ***Expand****, with explicit pass/fail gates and a documented rollback for every enforcing change.*

2. Requirements Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Verify **every** requirement before configuring. Each entry: **Description · Why required · How to verify · How to implement if missing.** The six category-wide Purview prerequisites (compliance licensing, least-privilege Purview roles + portal access, Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain, in-scope data sources/classification intent, compliance/records/privacy/legal stakeholders, and a pilot scope + change control) are in `global-requirements-purview.md` — confirm those **first**; this guide adds the **education/FERPA-specific** items and does not duplicate the six.

> ***Object names used throughout (use verbatim; names/periods are placeholders to confirm with your governance owners):*** *sensitivity labels* `EDU - Public`, `EDU - Internal`, `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`, `EDU - Highly Confidential`*; label policy* `EDU - Label Policy - Pilot` *(and* `- Prod`*); DLP policy* `EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot` *(created in* ***Test/simulation*** *mode); custom sensitive information type* `EDU - Student ID`*; retention label* `EDU - Student Education Record`*; retention/label policy* `EDU - Retention - Student Records - Pilot`*; Compliance Manager assessment* `EDU - FERPA Posture`*.*

2.1 Compliance licensing sufficient for the education capabilities (category G1)

Description: The tenant has the **compliance licensing** each capability needs — **E3** for baseline labeling/DLP, **E5 / E5 Compliance** for advanced DLP, **auto-labeling with simulation**, records management, and **premium Compliance Manager assessments** (some features are preview). **Why required:** Most of the education program's higher-value pieces are **plan-gated**; the feature will not be visible without the right plan. **How to verify:** M365 admin center → **Billing** → **Licenses** confirms E5 / E5 Compliance; the feature is visible in the Purview portal. Run `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1` (reports which capabilities the signed-in tenant exposes). **Verify your licensing/tenant** for any preview capability. **How to implement if missing:** Assign/purchase the required licensing before starting the affected step;

baseline labeling/DLP can proceed on E3 while advanced pieces wait for E5.

2.2 Least-privilege Purview roles for the education operators (category G2)

Description: The operators hold the **least-privilege Purview role groups** the work needs — **Information Protection** (labels), **Compliance Administrator / Compliance Data Administrator** (DLP), **Records Management** (retention/records), **Compliance Manager** roles, and **Audit** roles — with Global Administrator only where genuinely required. **Why required:** Purview uses fine-grained role groups; each configuration area requires the matching role group membership. **How to verify:** Purview portal → **Settings** → **Roles & scopes** → **Permissions**; confirm membership. Run `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1` (reports role-group membership for the signed-in admin where readable). **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role group under change control; avoid Global Admin for day-to-day label/DLP/retention work.

2.3 In-scope education workloads and the education-record data map (category G4)

Description: The **workloads in scope** — Exchange Online, SharePoint Online, OneDrive, Teams, and **endpoints/devices** (for endpoint DLP) — and a clear statement of **what constitutes an education record** in your tenant and **where it lives**. **Why required:** Labels, DLP, and retention all key off the in-scope workloads and the education-record definition; you cannot target what you have not scoped. **How to verify:** Confirm the in-scope workloads and the education-record locations with stakeholders; for endpoint DLP, devices are **onboarded** to Purview (Settings → Endpoint DLP / Defender onboarding). **How to implement if missing:** Define scope and the education-record data map before authoring policies; onboard devices before relying on endpoint DLP.

2.4 A custom sensitive information type for the institution's student ID

Description: A **custom SIT** `EDU - Student ID` matching your **student-identifier format** (regex/keywords), because there is **no universal built-in "FERPA" or "student record" SIT** — education- record detection is a **combination** of built-in SITs (names, U.S. SSN, etc.) plus your student ID. **Why required:** FERPA-oriented DLP and auto-labeling need to recognize education-record content; your student ID is the most reliable education-specific signal. **How to verify:** Purview → **Data classification** → **Sensitive info types** lists `EDU - Student ID` and test-matches sample values; run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (lists custom SITs). **How to implement if missing:** Build the custom SIT (Implementation Step 3) from your student-ID pattern with your data owners; validate match/false-positive rate before using it in policy.

2.5 The education sensitivity-label taxonomy is agreed

Description: An agreed, small **label taxonomy** for education — `EDU - Public`, `EDU - Internal`, `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`, `EDU - Highly Confidential` — with the **protection** each carries (encryption, marking, container protection) decided with information-protection and privacy owners. **Why required:** Labels are the backbone the DLP and retention design hangs off; publishing a taxonomy staff don't understand causes mislabeling. **How to verify:** The taxonomy + protection intent is documented and approved; run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` to see any labels already present. **How to implement if missing:** Agree the taxonomy with the information-protection/privacy owners (references the label-taxonomy

granular product) before publishing.

2.6 DLP simulation/Test mode available and to be used first (category G6)

Description: DLP policies will be created in **Test mode** (with or without policy tips) and auto-labeling in **simulation**, on a **pilot scope**, **before** any enforcement — confirm the tenant supports simulation for the capabilities you'll use. **Why required:** DLP and labeling are **high-impact**; enforcing untested rules blocks legitimate education work and generates support load. Simulation/Test surfaces what *would* happen safely. **How to verify:** In the Purview DLP/auto-labeling create flow the **Test / simulation** option is present; **verify your licensing/tenant** (auto-labeling simulation requires E5). **How to implement if missing:** If simulation isn't available for a capability, scope the pilot very narrowly and use monitor-only settings; do not enforce tenant-wide without a pilot.

2.7 Records schedule + retention determinations from the records/legal function (category G5)

Description: The **records schedule** for student education records — **retention periods**, **disposition** rules, and any **legal-hold** requirements — provided by the **records-management, privacy, and legal** stakeholders. **Why required:** Purview **enforces** retention; it does **not** decide it. The periods and disposition rules are a **records/legal determination**, not a technical default. **How to verify:** A documented records schedule with named approvers exists; the retention label `EDU - Student Education Record` will encode the approved period. **How to implement if missing:** Obtain the schedule and named approvers before configuring retention; do not invent retention periods.

2.8 Audit (Standard/Premium) enabled for evidence

Description: Purview Audit is **on** so label, DLP, and retention activity is logged — the evidence that the program operates (Audit **Premium** adds longer retention and richer events under E5). **Why required:** A defensible education-compliance posture needs an **audit trail**; Compliance Manager and any FERPA inquiry rely on it. **How to verify:** Purview → **Audit** shows the log **On**; run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (reports audit config state where readable). **How to implement if missing:** Turn on Audit (Standard is enabled by default in most tenants; confirm) and confirm Premium retention if your licensing includes it.

2.9 Compliance Manager access + an education assessment template

Description: Access to **Compliance Manager** and an **education/FERPA (or data-protection) assessment template** — premium templates require **E5 Compliance**; the built-in **Data Protection Baseline** is available more broadly. **Why required:** Compliance Manager turns the program into a **scored, evidenced posture** with improvement actions. **How to verify:** Purview → **Compliance Manager** → **Assessments**; the desired template is available (**verify your licensing/tenant** for premium templates). **How to implement if missing:** If the premium FERPA template isn't licensed, start from the **Data Protection Baseline** and map education controls to it; add the premium assessment when licensed.

2.10 Pilot scope + change control for enforcing changes (category G6)

Description: A named **pilot scope** (a group of users/sites for label publishing and DLP Test) and a **change-control** window before any DLP **Enforce**, label **mandatory** publishing, or retention **apply** goes

tenant-wide. **Why required:** Every enforcing change is high-impact in an education tenant (blocking staff/students, relabeling, applying retention). The pilot + change control protect production. **How to verify:** A named pilot user/site group and an approval window exist. **How to implement if missing:** Define the pilot group and agree change control before enforcing.

Checklist

- Compliance licensing sufficient (E3 baseline / E5 for advanced) (2.1 / category G1)
- Least-privilege Purview role groups on the operators (2.2 / category G2)
- In-scope education workloads + education-record data map; devices onboarded for endpoint DLP (2.3 / G4)
- Custom SIT `EDU - Student ID` built and validated (2.4)
- Education label taxonomy agreed with protection intent (2.5)
- DLP Test/simulation available and to be used first (2.6 / G6)
- Records schedule + retention periods + legal-hold reqs from records/legal (2.7 / G5)
- Purview Audit enabled (Premium where licensed) (2.8)
- Compliance Manager access + education/FERPA (or baseline) assessment template (2.9)
- Pilot scope + change-control window agreed (2.10 / G6)

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions

These requirements apply to **every** solution in the **Purview** category (implementing and managing Microsoft Purview, sensitivity & retention labels, DLP, data lifecycle & records, insider risk, communication compliance, audit, data security posture management, and data governance). Verify each before starting a solution's implementation steps.

> ***Vendor boundary (applies to every Purview solution).*** *The **Microsoft Purview portal** (purview.microsoft.com), the **Microsoft 365 admin center**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`), and **Microsoft Graph** are authored at exact, current click-by-click / cmdlet detail from Microsoft's public documentation. Microsoft Purview features are heavily **licensing-/plan-dependent** (many require **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on; some are in preview) and the portal is **actively evolving** — capability availability and portal paths are **cited or flagged "verify your licensing/tenant"**, never asserted or invented. **Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations** (retention schedules, records file plans, legal holds, insider-risk case actions, regulatory applicability) are **deferred to the organization's compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions** — the solutions provide the technical configuration method and evidence, not the determination. Automation is **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets.*

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing

- **Description:** A Microsoft 365 tenant with the **compliance licensing** the capability requires

(E3 for baseline; **E5 / E5 Compliance** for advanced DLP, auto-labeling, insider risk, communication compliance, Audit Premium, DSPM, etc.).

- **Why required:** Most Purview capabilities are plan-gated; the feature won't be available without the right plan.
- **How to verify:** In the M365 admin center confirm the subscription/add-ons; check the feature is visible in the Purview portal.
- **How to implement if missing:** Assign/purchase the required licensing before starting.

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access

- **Description:** Access with the least-privilege **Purview / compliance role** the solution names (e.g. Compliance Administrator, Compliance Data Administrator, Information Protection, Records Management, Insider Risk, eDiscovery, Audit roles), with Global Administrator only where required.
- **Why required:** Purview uses fine-grained role groups; configuration requires the matching role.
- **How to verify:** Purview portal → **Roles & scopes / Permissions** — confirm the role membership.
- **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role group under change control.

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain

- **Description:** A workstation with **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession` via the ExchangeOnlineManagement module) and **Microsoft Graph PowerShell**, modern-auth / MFA-capable admin.
- **Why required:** Configuration, automation, and the provided scripts run through these.
- **How to verify:** `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-MgGraph` succeed with the admin account.
- **How to implement if missing:** Install the modules and confirm modern-auth sign-in before running steps.

4. Data sources & scope in scope

- **Description:** The **workloads and data sources** in scope (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, endpoints/devices, and — for data governance — the broader data estate) and a **data-classification / sensitivity** intent to drive labels, DLP, and retention.
- **Why required:** Purview policies key off the in-scope workloads and the classification scheme.
- **How to verify:** Confirm the in-scope workloads and the classification/sensitivity approach with stakeholders.
- **How to implement if missing:** Define the scope and classification intent before authoring policies.

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders

• **Description:** Engagement with the **compliance, records-management, privacy, security, and legal**

stakeholders whose policies the configuration must satisfy (retention schedules, records file plans, regulatory obligations, insider-risk and communication-compliance policy, legal hold).

• **Why required:** Purview configuration must align to enterprise policy and legal/records requirements,

not technical defaults; several capabilities have HR/legal sensitivity.

• **How to verify:** Confirm the applicable policies, the records schedule, and named approvers.

• **How to implement if missing:** Identify the owners and capture the requirements before configuring.

6. A pilot scope and change control

• **Description:** A **pilot scope** (users/sites/policies in simulation or a limited ring) to validate

on before tenant-wide enforcement, and a **change-control** process — most Purview policies support a **simulation / test / disabled** mode that MUST be used before enforcement.

• **Why required:** Every solution follows an **Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (simulate) → Validate

→ Expand (enforce)** model; DLP, labels, retention, and insider-risk changes are high-impact.

• **How to verify:** Confirm a named pilot scope, that simulation/test mode is available, and a change

window/approval path.

• **How to implement if missing:** Define the pilot and agree change control before enforcing anything.

*The deployment model across every Purview solution is the same: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate/test)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)**, with explicit pass/fail gates and a documented rollback. Automation is delivered as **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets. Regulatory/records/legal determinations are deferred to the relevant governance functions.*

3. Implementation Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Follow these steps **in order**. **Purview portal** navigation and **Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph** cmdlets are given from Microsoft's public documentation. Where a capability is **plan-gated or in preview**, the step flags **"verify your licensing/tenant." Regulatory/records/legal determinations** (FERPA applicability, retention periods, file plans, legal holds) are the institution's governance calls — this guide configures the **method**, not the determination.

Consoles used:

• **Microsoft Purview portal** — `https://purview.microsoft.com`

• **Microsoft 365 admin center** — `https://admin.microsoft.com` (licensing/roles)

• **Security & Compliance PowerShell** — `Connect-IPPSSession` (ExchangeOnlineManagement module)

• **Microsoft Graph** — reporting/read helpers

Model: *Configure labels, DLP (**Test/simulation**), retention, and Compliance Manager; **pilot in simulation/test** on the pilot scope; validate against pass/fail gates; then **enforce and expand** in waves. **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce).***

Artifact names (use verbatim; names/periods are placeholders to confirm with governance owners): *labels* `EDU - Public` / `EDU - Internal` / `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` / `EDU - Highly Confidential`*; label policy* `EDU - Label Policy - Pilot`*; custom SIT* `EDU - Student ID`*; DLP policy* `EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot` *(**Test** mode); retention label* `EDU - Student Education Record`*; retention/label policy* `EDU - Retention - Student Records - Pilot`*; Compliance Manager assessment* `EDU - FERPA Posture`*.*

Risk + rollback (read first): *Labels, DLP, and retention are **high-impact**. **Nothing enforces in this guide until validated.** DLP is created in **Test** mode; auto-labeling runs in **simulation**; labels publish to a **pilot scope** first; retention is applied only after the records owner confirms the schedule. **Rollback:** a DLP policy in **Test** blocks no one — to revert, set it back to Test or **disable/delete** it; to unpublish labels, **remove the label policy** (or the pilot group from it) — the labels remain but stop being offered; auto-labeling **simulation** applies nothing until you turn it on. **Retention, once applied, preserves content and is harder to reverse — do not apply retention until the records owner has signed off the period** (a retention *label* can be unpublished, but content already retained stays retained for the period). Pilot everything on a **small** scope first.*

Phase 1 — Assess and prepare (no changes)

Step 1 — Baseline the tenant and confirm licensing/roles

1. Run `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1` — it reports the compliance licensing the tenant exposes, the operator's Purview role-group membership (where readable), and the in-scope workloads, and flags gaps against the Requirements Guide. **Verify your licensing/tenant** for any preview capability.

1. Run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` — read-only inventory of existing sensitivity labels, label policies, DLP policies (and their mode), retention labels/policies, custom SITs, and audit state, so you build **on** the current tenant rather than duplicating.

1. Confirm the education-record **data map** and the **records schedule** with the records/privacy/legal owners (Requirements 2.3, 2.7). **Do not invent retention periods.**

Phase 2 — Classification foundation (labels + SIT)

Step 2 — Create the education sensitivity-label taxonomy

1. Purview → **Information Protection** → **Sensitivity labels** → **Create a label** (or `New-Label` in S&C PowerShell). Create, in order (parent labels first if you use sublabels):

• `EDU - Public` — no protection; marking optional.

• `EDU - Internal` — internal-only; header/footer marking.

• `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` — **encryption + content marking** (e.g. "FERPA — Student Record");

scope to files/emails (and containers if used for student-data sites/Teams).

• `EDU - Highly Confidential` — strongest encryption/marking for the most sensitive records.

1. Set each label's **protection** (encryption, content marking, container settings) per the taxonomy

approved in Requirement 2.5. Keep protection **minimal for the pilot** and tighten later.

1. Prefer automation? `EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Labels` creates the label set via S&C

PowerShell — default `-WhatIf`; add `-Commit` to write.

Step 3 — Build the custom `EDU - Student ID` sensitive information type

1. Purview → **Data classification** → **Sensitive info types** → **Create sensitive info type** (or

`New-DlpSensitiveInformationType`). Name it `EDU - Student ID`; define the **pattern** (regex + supporting keywords) that matches **your** student-identifier format, with a confidence level and proximity to keywords (e.g. "student ID", "SID").

1. **Test** it against sample values in the create flow; tune to minimize false positives.

2. This SIT plus built-in SITs (names, U.S. SSN, etc.) become the **education-record** condition your

DLP and (optionally) auto-labeling use. There is **no universal built-in FERPA SIT** — this is the education-specific signal you provide.

Step 4 — Publish the labels to the pilot scope

1. Purview → **Information Protection** → **Label policies** → **Publish label** (or `New-LabelPolicy`). Name it

`EDU - Label Policy - Pilot`; **assign it to the pilot user group** (Requirement 2.10).

1. Set policy options for the pilot (e.g. a **default label** of `EDU - Internal`, **not mandatory**

yet, allow users to justify downgrades). **Mandatory labeling is an enforcing change — defer it to the expand phase.**

1. **Pass/fail gate:** pilot users see the four labels in Office apps within the publish window

(typically up to a few hours). Validate with the Testing Guide before widening.

Phase 3 — DLP in Test/simulation

Step 5 — Create the FERPA-oriented DLP policy in Test mode

1. Purview → **Data Loss Prevention** → **Policies** → **Create policy** (or `New-DlpCompliancePolicy` +

`New-DlpComplianceRule`). Name it `EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot`.

1. **Locations:** Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, and **Devices** (endpoint DLP — only if devices

are onboarded, Requirement 2.3). Scope to the **pilot** where the location supports scoping.

1. **Conditions (education-record detection):** content contains `EDU - Student ID` **AND** (a name SIT

or U.S. SSN), **OR** the file/email carries the `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` label. Tune counts and confidence to your false-positive tolerance.

1. **Actions:** restrict sharing **outside the organization**, notify the user with a **policy tip**,

and generate an **incident report** — but set the policy **status to Test** (with or without policy tips). **Do not enforce.**

1. Automate with `EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area DLP` — it creates the policy in **Test** mode by

default; it will **not** enable enforcement even with `-Commit` (enforcement is a deliberate, separate, out-of-band change in Step 9).

1. **Pass/fail gate:** the policy exists in **Test**; `EDU-Validation.ps1` confirms mode = Test and

the rule conditions are present.

Step 6 — (Optional) Auto-labeling in simulation

1. If licensed (**E5**, verify), Purview → **Information Protection** → **Auto-labeling** → **Create policy** to

auto-apply `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` where education-record content is detected (using the `EDU - Student ID` SIT). **Run it in simulation** — it labels **nothing** until you review results and turn it on.

1. Let simulation accumulate matches; review the simulated items for accuracy before ever enabling.

Phase 4 — Retention & records (schedule-driven)

Step 7 — Configure student-record retention (per the approved schedule)

1. **Only after the records owner signs off the schedule** (Requirement 2.7). Purview → **Data

Lifecycle Management **(or** Records Management **if declaring records)** → Retention labels → Create a label `EDU - Student Education Record`**; set the** retention period and disposition **to the** records owner's approved values **(placeholder here — do** not** invent).

1. **Publish** the label via a **retention label policy** `EDU - Retention - Student Records - Pilot` to

the pilot SharePoint/OneDrive/Exchange locations, **or** apply it via an **auto-apply retention policy** keyed on the education-record condition (Step 5 logic). Use **disposition review** where records management requires human sign-off before deletion.

1. **Pass/fail gate:** the retention label exists with the approved period and is published to the pilot;

`EDU-Validation.ps1` confirms it. Remember retention **preserves content** — confirm the period before applying broadly.

Phase 5 — Posture, validate, and expand

Step 8 — Stand up the Compliance Manager posture

1. Purview → **Compliance Manager** → **Assessments** → **Add assessment**; choose the **education/FERPA**

template if licensed (else the **Data Protection Baseline**), name it `EDU - FERPA Posture`.

1. Work the **improvement actions** the assessment lists, attaching evidence (the labels/DLP/retention you configured, plus Audit). This produces the **defensible, scored** posture.

Step 9 — Validate the pilot, then expand to enforce (waves)

1. Complete the **Testing Guide** pilot gates: labels visible, DLP catching in Test (review the simulated/Test matches), retention applied on the pilot, auto-label simulation accurate, audit logging.

1. **Only after the gates pass and change control approves**, expand:

• Create production twins (`EDU - Label Policy - Prod`, `EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Prod`, `EDU - Retention - Student Records - Prod`) or widen the pilot policies.

• **Turn DLP from Test** → **Enforce** for the production scope (this is the deliberate enforcing change).

• Publish labels tenant-wide (and consider **mandatory** labeling once staff are trained).

• Turn **auto-labeling** from simulation → on, after reviewing simulation results.

1. Re-run `EDU-Validation.ps1` and `EDU-Report.ps1` after each wave; validate before widening.

Order of operations

`Baseline (Scope-Health + Discovery) → create labels → build EDU - Student ID SIT → publish labels to pilot → DLP in Test (education-record conditions) → (auto-label simulation) → retention per approved schedule → Compliance Manager posture → validate pilot gates → expand: DLP Test→Enforce, labels tenant-wide, auto-label on — in waves, validating each`

5. Testing Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Run after the labels, DLP (Test), retention, and Compliance Manager posture are configured (Implementation Steps 2–8), on the **pilot scope**, and again after each expansion wave. Back each test with `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (inventory), `EDU-Validation.ps1` (policy-state checks), and `EDU-Report.ps1` (activity/matches). **No test requires enforcing anything** — DLP stays in **Test** and auto-labeling in **simulation** until the pilot passes.

Test 1 — Compliance licensing + roles are sufficient

Do: Run `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1`. **Expected:** The tenant exposes the capabilities each step needs (E5/E5 Compliance where required); the operator holds the least-privilege Purview role groups. Any plan-gated/preview gap is flagged **"verify your licensing/tenant."**

Test 2 — The education label taxonomy exists and is published to the pilot

Do: Run `EDU-Discovery.ps1`; in an Office app signed in as a **pilot** user, open the **Sensitivity** menu. **Expected:** `EDU - Public`, `EDU - Internal`, `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`, `EDU - Highly Confidential` exist and are **offered to pilot users** (label policy `EDU - Label Policy - Pilot` assigned to the pilot group); non-pilot users do **not** yet see them.

Test 3 — Applying the Student Record label protects the file

Do: As a pilot user, apply `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` to a test document. **Expected:** The label's **protection applies** — content marking appears and (if configured) encryption restricts access per the label. Downgrade prompts for justification if so configured.

Test 4 — The `EDU - Student ID` SIT matches education-record content

Do: Run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (lists custom SITs); in **Data classification** → **Sensitive info types**, test `EDU - Student ID` against sample student-ID values and a non-matching value. **Expected:** Real student-ID values **match** at the expected confidence; obvious non-matches do **not**. False-positive rate is acceptable to the data owner.

Test 5 — DLP is in Test mode with the education-record conditions

Do: Run `EDU-Validation.ps1`. **Expected:** `EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot` exists, **mode = Test** (not Enforce), across the intended locations, with conditions detecting education-record content (`EDU - Student ID` + name/SSN, or the `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` label).

Test 6 — DLP catches a simulated education-record leak (in Test, blocks no one)

Do: As a pilot user, attempt to **share externally** a test document containing sample student-ID + name content (synthetic data only). Then run `EDU-Report.ps1`. **Expected:** The action **is not blocked** (Test mode) but a **policy tip / incident** is generated and appears in the DLP activity/report — proving the rule *would* catch a real leak before you enforce.

Test 7 — Auto-labeling simulation is accurate (if configured)

Do: If Step 6 was done, review the **auto-labeling simulation** results in the portal. **Expected:** The simulation flags education-record documents for `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` with acceptable accuracy and **labels nothing** — you review before enabling.

Test 8 — Retention label exists with the approved period and is published

Do: Run `EDU-Validation.ps1`; check **Data Lifecycle / Records Management** → **Retention labels**. **Expected:** `EDU - Student Education Record` exists with the **records owner's approved** period and disposition, published via `EDU - Retention - Student Records - Pilot` to the pilot locations. (The period is a **records determination** — this test confirms it matches the signed-off schedule, not that it is "correct" legally.)

Test 9 — Audit is logging label/DLP/retention activity

Do: Run `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (audit state); in Purview → **Audit**, search for recent label/DLP events from Tests 3 and 6. **Expected:** Audit is **On** and the label-apply and DLP events are searchable — the evidence trail exists (Premium retention if licensed).

Test 10 — Compliance Manager posture is scored with evidence

Do: Open **Compliance Manager** → `EDU - FERPA Posture`. **Expected:** The assessment shows a **score** with improvement actions; the configured labels/DLP/ retention/audit map to actions and evidence is attachable — a defensible, measured posture.

Pass/fail gate

Gate	Requirement
Foundation pass	Tests 1–4 pass (licensing/roles; labels published to pilot; label protects; Student-ID SIT accurate)
Protection pass	Tests 5–8 pass (DLP in Test with correct conditions; catches simulated leak; auto-label simulation accurate; retention per approved schedule)
Evidence pass	Tests 9–10 pass (audit logging; Compliance Manager scored with evidence)

> *Do not expand beyond the pilot or move **DLP Test** → **Enforce** / labels tenant-wide until all three gates pass **and** change control approves. Re-run Tests 5–10 after each expansion wave.*

6. Troubleshooting Guide — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Symptom → likely root cause → fix. Use `EDU-Discovery.ps1` (inventory), `EDU-Validation.ps1` (policy state), `EDU-Report.ps1` (activity/matches), and `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1` (licensing/ roles) to confirm before and after each fix. Where a capability is **plan-gated or the portal path is version-dependent, verify your licensing/tenant / against current Microsoft guidance** rather than assuming.

A. Licensing & roles

A capability (advanced DLP, auto-label simulation, records management, premium assessment) isn't visible

• **Plan-gated.** These require **E5 / E5 Compliance** (some are preview). **Fix:** run

`EDU-Scope-Health.ps1`; assign/purchase the licensing (Requirement 2.1), or use the E3-level baseline for now. **Verify your licensing/tenant** for preview features.

"You don't have permission" creating a label / DLP / retention policy

• **Missing Purview role group.** Labels need **Information Protection**; DLP needs **Compliance

Administrator/Data Administrator**; retention needs** Records Management**.** Fix: **assign the least-privilege role group (Requirement 2.2); confirm in** Roles & scopes → Permissions**.

B. Sensitivity labels

Pilot users don't see the education labels in Office

- **Label policy not assigned / still propagating.** Publishing via `EDU - Label Policy - Pilot` can

take time to reach clients. **Fix:** confirm the pilot group is on the policy (`EDU-Validation.ps1`); wait the publish window; have the user sign out/in.

- **User not in the pilot group. Fix:** add them to the pilot group or confirm scope; non-pilot

users are **not** meant to see the labels yet.

Applying `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` *doesn't protect the file*

- **Label has no protection configured.** A label without encryption/marking classifies but doesn't

protect. **Fix:** edit the label → set **encryption + content marking** (Requirement 2.5 / Step 2); re-apply.

- **Client cache. Fix:** wait for the label refresh / restart the Office app.

C. Sensitive information type (student ID)

DLP/auto-label misses obvious education-record documents

- `EDU - Student ID` **SIT pattern too narrow / wrong. Fix:** in **Data classification → Sensitive

info types**, test `EDU - Student ID` against real sample formats; broaden the regex/keywords and confidence; `EDU-Discovery.ps1` confirms the SIT exists.

- **Relying on a built-in "FERPA" SIT that doesn't exist.** There is **no universal FERPA SIT** — you

must use `EDU - Student ID` + built-in SITs. **Fix:** build/confirm the custom SIT (Step 3).

Too many false positives

- **Confidence/proximity too loose. Fix:** raise the confidence level and require a nearby keyword

("student ID", "SID"); increase the instance count; re-test in Test mode before enforcing.

D. Data Loss Prevention

DLP isn't blocking external sharing of student records

- **Policy is in Test mode — by design.** In Test, DLP **detects but does not block**. **Fix:** this is

expected during the pilot; review matches in `EDU-Report.ps1`, and only move **Test** → **Enforce** after the pilot passes and change control approves (Implementation Step 9).

- **Location not covered / device not onboarded.** Endpoint DLP needs devices **onboarded**. **Fix:**

confirm locations in `EDU-Validation.ps1`; onboard devices (Requirement 2.3) for endpoint coverage.

DLP is blocking legitimate teaching/registrar work

- **Conditions too broad / enforced too early. Fix:** set the policy back to **Test**

(`EDU-Validation.ps1` flags enforcing policies), tune the education-record conditions, and re-validate before re-enforcing. Roll back first, tune second.

No DLP matches at all in Test

- **Conditions don't match your content, or SIT is off. Fix:** confirm the rule uses

`EDU - Student ID` + name/SSN **or** the `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)` label (`EDU-Validation.ps1`); test with synthetic student-record content (Testing Test 6).

E. Auto-labeling

Auto-labeling isn't applying `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`

- **Still in simulation — by design.** Simulation **labels nothing**. **Fix:** review simulation

results; enable only after they're accurate (and licensing supports it — **verify your licensing/tenant**).

F. Retention & records

Retention label isn't available to apply / not appearing on sites

- **Label policy not published to the location / propagation delay. Fix:** confirm

`EDU - Retention - Student Records - Pilot` targets the pilot locations (`EDU-Validation.ps1`); allow propagation time.

Wrong retention period / disposition

- **Period was set without the records owner's sign-off.** Retention is a **records determination**.

Fix: correct the label to the **approved** period/disposition; **note that content already retained stays retained for the period** even after a label change — engage the records owner. **Do not invent periods.**

Content was deleted that should have been kept (or vice-versa)

- **Disposition/label mismatch with the schedule. Fix:** review the label's retain/delete settings

against the signed-off schedule with records management; use **disposition review** so deletions require human sign-off. Escalate as a **records incident** — this is a governance matter, not just a config fix.

G. Audit & evidence

Label/DLP/retention activity isn't searchable in Audit

- **Audit off, or event still indexing. Fix:** confirm Audit is **On** (Purview → **Audit**;

`EDU-Discovery.ps1` reports state); allow indexing latency; confirm **Premium** retention if you need older events (licensing).

Compliance Manager score isn't moving

- **Improvement actions not worked / evidence not attached. Fix:** in `EDU - FERPA Posture`, complete

the improvement actions and attach the configured labels/DLP/retention/audit as evidence.

Escalation checklist

1. `EDU-Scope-Health.ps1` — licensing sufficient, operator holds the right Purview role groups?
2. `EDU-Discovery.ps1` — labels, `EDU - Student ID` SIT, DLP (and mode), retention labels, audit all present?
3. `EDU-Validation.ps1` — DLP in **Test** (nothing accidentally enforcing), label policy targets the pilot, retention period matches the signed-off schedule, DLP conditions reference the education-record signal?
4. `EDU-Report.ps1` — DLP matches/incidents as expected in Test; label usage and retention coverage sane?
5. Still stuck → capture the symptom and **verify against current Microsoft guidance / your tenant** (Purview paths and plan-gating evolve); route **records/legal/privacy determinations** to the governance owners — they are not technical fixes.

7. Best Practices — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Field-proven recommendations for an education-tailored Purview program that is accurate, defensible, and low-friction for staff and students.

Design

• **Let governance own the determinations.** FERPA applicability, retention periods, file plans, and legal holds are **records/privacy/legal** calls. Configure Purview to **enforce** them; never invent a retention period or decide what an education record is on your own. Capture named approvers.

• **Keep the label taxonomy small and human.** Four labels staff understand (`EDU - Public` → `EDU - Highly Confidential`, with `EDU - Student Record (FERPA)`) beat a sprawling set nobody applies correctly. Complexity causes mislabeling, which undermines every downstream control.

• **Make the student ID the anchor signal.** Education-record detection is only as good as your **custom** `EDU - Student ID` **SIT**. Invest in getting its pattern and false-positive rate right — it is what makes DLP and auto-labeling "understand" education records. There is **no built-in FERPA SIT**.

• **Design labels → DLP → retention as one chain.** Labels classify, DLP protects the labeled/detected data, retention keeps and disposes it. Wiring them to the **same** education-record definition keeps the program coherent (the whole point of the industry bundle).

Pilot in simulation/test — always

• **Never enforce first.** Create DLP in **Test** and auto-labeling in **simulation**, on a **pilot scope**, every time. Review what *would* happen before it happens. This is the single most important habit in a live education tenant.

- **Read the Test/simulation results before enforcing.** A Test DLP policy and an auto-label simulation exist to be *reviewed*. Move to Enforce/on only after the matches look right and change control approves — then expand in waves, validating each.
- **Use synthetic data for testing.** Test DLP and labels with **fake** student records, never real ones — testing must not itself create a FERPA exposure.

Accuracy and friction

- **Tune for false positives before you enforce.** Over-eager DLP blocks legitimate teaching/registrar work and trains staff to route around it. Adjust SIT confidence, instance counts, and conditions in Test until precision is acceptable.
- **Publish labels with a sensible default, not mandatory (at first).** Start with a default label and optional justification; only make labeling **mandatory** after staff are trained — mandatory is an enforcing change.
- **Protect containers used for student data.** Where student records live in specific Teams/SharePoint sites, use **container labels** so the site itself carries protection, not just individual files.

Retention & records (handle with extra care)

- **Retention preserves content — confirm the period first.** Once applied, retained content stays for the period even if you unpublish the label. **Do not apply retention until the records owner signs off the schedule.** Use **disposition review** where records management requires human sign-off before deletion.
- **Separate "retain" from "delete."** Be explicit about whether a label retains-then-deletes, retains-only, or deletes-only, and match it to the records schedule — a wrong disposition rule is a records incident.

Evidence & posture

- **Turn Audit on and keep it on.** Label, DLP, and retention activity in the audit log is your evidence the program operates. Use **Audit Premium** retention where licensed.
- **Work Compliance Manager continuously.** Treat `EDU - FERPA Posture` improvement actions as a living backlog with attached evidence — it turns a pile of policies into a **scored, defensible** posture for any FERPA inquiry.

Operations, automation & security

- **Run the scripts read-only first.** `EDU-Discovery` / `EDU-Validation` / `EDU-Report` / `EDU-Scope-Health` are read-only; `EDU-Set-Configuration` defaults to `-WhatIf` and creates DLP in **Test** even with `-Commit`. Preview before you write; enforcement is always a separate, deliberate, human step.

• **Least privilege, no secrets.** Connect with the **least Purview role groups / Graph scopes** each

task needs; **never** put credentials, tokens, or student data in scripts or source control. Use modern-auth / MFA admin accounts.

• **Verify licensing/tenant at every plan-gated step.** Advanced DLP, auto-labeling simulation, records

management, and premium Compliance Manager assessments require **E5 / E5 Compliance** and the portal evolves — confirm availability and paths against **current Microsoft guidance / your tenant** rather than assuming.

• **Document rollback for every enforcing change.** Know the revert before you enforce: set DLP back to

Test / disable it; remove the pilot group from the label policy to stop offering labels; remember **retained content stays retained** — which is exactly why retention goes last and only after sign-off.

8. Deliverables Summary — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA)

Documentation

Document	Purpose
Executive Summary	Business case: an education-tailored, FERPA-aligned Purview program, piloted in simulation/test and defensible
1. Solution Overview	The education-fit program (labels/DLP/retention/posture), why "tailored to education" matters, industry-bundle model, what's authored vs deferred
2. Requirements Guide	Every education/FERPA prerequisite with Verify / Implement-if-missing (the six category Purview GRs referenced, not duplicated)
Global Requirements (Purview)	Category-wide Purview prerequisites, published once
3. Implementation Guide	Exact, ordered Purview portal + S&C PowerShell + Graph steps: labels → custom Student-ID SIT → publish to pilot → DLP in Test → (auto-label simulation) → retention per approved schedule → Compliance Manager; pilot-in-simulation-first, pass/fail + rollback
5. Testing Guide	Validation procedures with pass/fail gates (nothing enforced)
6. Troubleshooting Guide	Labels, DLP, retention, SIT, licensing, and audit issues by symptom → root cause → fix
7. Best Practices	Field-proven recommendations; pilot-in-simulation discipline; determinations deferred to governance

PowerShell scripts (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Microsoft Graph)

Script	What it does	Safety
`EDU-Discovery.ps1`	Read-only inventory: sensitivity labels + label policies, DLP policies **and their mode**, retention labels/policies, custom SITs (incl. `EDU - Student ID`), and audit state	Read-only
`EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1`	Creates the education label set, the FERPA DLP policy **in Test mode**, and the retention label — `-Area Labels/DLP/Retention`	Default `-WhatIf`; `-Commit` to write; **DLP always created in Test — never enforces**
`EDU-Validation.ps1`	Policy-state checks: DLP is in **Test** (flags any enforcing), label policy targets the pilot, retention label has the approved period, DLP conditions reference the education-record signal	Read-only
`EDU-Report.ps1`	Activity/coverage: DLP match/incident counts (Test + enforced), label usage, and disposition/retention coverage where readable	Read-only
`EDU-Scope-Health.ps1`	Readiness helper: compliance licensing the tenant exposes, operator Purview role-group membership (where readable), in-scope workloads, and gaps vs the Requirements Guide	Read-only

What the buyer receives

- This implementation guide as a **PDF** (and, per the factory, a white-label local copy).
- All five **PowerShell scripts** in a single ZIP.
- A repeatable process: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce).**

Outcome

A Microsoft Purview program **tailored to education and aligned to FERPA** — an agreed label taxonomy published to a pilot, a custom student-ID sensitive information type anchoring FERPA-oriented DLP proven

in **Test/simulation** before it blocks anyone, student-record retention enforced to the records owner's approved schedule, and a **scored, evidenced** Compliance Manager posture — configured, validated against pass/fail gates, and defensible. Regulatory, records, and legal determinations remain with the institution's governance functions.

Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts

Included in the accompanying ZIP. Each script's header documents full usage.

EDU-Discovery.ps1

Purpose: Assesses the current Microsoft Purview configuration relevant to an education/FERPA program: sensitivity labels + label policies, DLP compliance policies AND THEIR MODE (Test vs Enable), retention labels/policies, custom sensitive information types (incl. the education Student-ID SIT), and the unified-audit state. Read-only against Security & Compliance PowerShell — makes no changes. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Discovery.ps1 Requires the ExchangeOnlineManagement module. Connects with Connect-IPPSSession (Security & Compliance PowerShell) using an MFA-capable admin holding read access to the compliance config. Optional: -SitNameFilter 'EDU - Student ID' to spotlight the education SIT. EXPECTED RESULTS Lists education-relevant labels, each DLP policy with its MODE flagged (Test = safe pilot, Enable = ENFORCING), retention labels with their retention action/duration, custom SITs, and the unified-audit ingestion state. Nothing is modified. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Capability availability is licensing-/plan-dependent (E5 / E5 Compliance; some preview) — verify your licensing/tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$LabelNameFilter = 'EDU', [string]$SitNameFilter = 'EDU - Student ID')

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Discovery.ps1 Requires the ExchangeOnlineManagement module. Connects with Connect-IPPSSession (Security & Compliance PowerShell) using an MFA-capable admin holding read access to the compliance config. Optional: -SitNameFilter 'EDU - Student ID' to spotlight the education SIT. EXPECTED RESULTS Lists education-relevant labels, each DLP policy with its MODE flagged (Test = safe pilot, Enable = ENFORCING), retention labels with their retention action/duration, custom SITs, and the unified-audit ingestion state. Nothing is modified. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Capability availability is licensing-/plan-dependent (E5 / E5 Compliance; some preview) — verify your licensing/tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$LabelNameFilter = 'EDU', [string]$SitNameFilter = 'EDU - Student ID')

EDU-Report.ps1

Purpose: Produces a coverage/activity snapshot with no changes: the education DLP policies with their mode (Test vs enforcing) and recent DLP match/incident counts where the reporting cmdlet is available, the education sensitivity labels and their publishing policies, and the student-record retention label/policy coverage. Writes only a local CSV/JSON report. Read-only. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Report.ps1 -OutputDir .\report -Days 30 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). DLP incident/match counts use the Security & Compliance reporting cmdlet where present (verify availability/latency for your tenant). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin; no secrets in code. EXPECTED RESULTS A timestamped report (CSV + JSON) of DLP policies + mode + match counts, label/label-policy coverage, and retention coverage — evidence for the Compliance Manager 'EDU - FERPA Posture' assessment. Nothing is modified. Counts are indicative; reporting latency applies. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only (emits a local report only). Capability/report availability is licensing-/tenant-dependent and evolving — verify. FERPA applicability, retention adequacy, and holds are records/legal determinations. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$OutputDir = '.\report', [int]$Days = 30, [string]$DlpFilter = 'EDU', [string]$RetentionLabel = 'EDU -

Student Education Record')

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Report.ps1 -OutputDir .\report -Days 30 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). DLP incident/match counts use the Security & Compliance reporting cmdlet where present (verify availability/latency for your tenant). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin; no secrets in code. EXPECTED RESULTS A timestamped report (CSV + JSON) of DLP policies + mode + match counts, label/label-policy coverage, and retention coverage — evidence for the Compliance Manager 'EDU - FERPA Posture' assessment. Nothing is modified. Counts are indicative; reporting latency applies. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only (emits a local report only). Capability/report availability is licensing-/tenant-dependent and evolving — verify. FERPA applicability, retention adequacy, and holds are records/legal determinations. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$OutputDir = '.\report', [int]$Days = 30, [string]$DlpFilter = 'EDU', [string]$RetentionLabel = 'EDU - Student Education Record')

EDU-Scope-Health.ps1

Purpose: Reports whether the tenant is ready for the education/FERPA Purview program before you configure anything: the compliance licensing the tenant exposes (via Microsoft Graph subscribedSkus), the operator's visible Purview role-group membership, the in-scope workloads, and the gaps against the Requirements Guide. Read-only — makes no changes. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Scope-Health.ps1 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession) and, for licensing, Microsoft.Graph with delegated Organization.Read.All / Directory.Read.All. MFA-capable admin; no secrets in code. Optional: -PilotGroup 'EDU Pilot Users' to check the pilot group resolves. EXPECTED RESULTS A readiness summary: indicative compliance plans present (flagged "verify for your tenant"), visible compliance role groups, and reachability of the S&C PowerShell / Graph endpoints. PASS = licensing present + endpoints reachable + roles visible; FAIL = a gap to close first. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Capability availability is licensing-/plan-dependent (E5 / E5 Compliance; some preview) — verify your licensing/tenant. Plan and service-plan names change; confirm against your entitlements and current Microsoft documentation. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PilotGroup, [switch]$SkipGraph)

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Scope-Health.ps1 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession) and, for licensing, Microsoft.Graph with delegated Organization.Read.All / Directory.Read.All. MFA-capable admin; no secrets in code. Optional: -PilotGroup 'EDU Pilot Users' to check the pilot group resolves. EXPECTED RESULTS A readiness summary: indicative compliance plans present (flagged "verify for your tenant"), visible compliance role groups, and reachability of the S&C PowerShell / Graph endpoints. PASS = licensing present + endpoints reachable + roles visible; FAIL = a gap to close first. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Capability availability is licensing-/plan-dependent (E5 / E5 Compliance; some preview) — verify your licensing/tenant. Plan and service-plan names change; confirm against your entitlements and current Microsoft documentation. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$PilotGroup, [switch]$SkipGraph)

EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1

Purpose: Configures one area of the education/FERPA program at a time (-Area Labels|DLP|Retention) using Security & Compliance PowerShell. SAFE BY DEFAULT: prints the exact cmdlet it WOULD run and makes NO change unless -Commit is passed. The DLP policy is ALWAYS created in TEST mode and this script will NOT enable enforcement (that is a deliberate, separate change per Implementation Step 9).

Retention is applied ONLY with an approved period you pass — the script never invents a period. HOW TO RUN Labels (preview then commit): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Labels -WhatIf .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Labels -Commit FERPA DLP policy IN TEST (references the 'EDU - Student ID' SIT / 'EDU - Student Record (FERPA)' label): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area DLP -WhatIf Student-record retention label (period from the records owner — REQUIRED, no default): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Retention -RetentionYears 5 -Commit Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin. EXPECTED RESULTS -WhatIf prints each intended create with no change. -Commit performs it and re-reads the object. PASS = objects exist as intended, DLP in Test. Nothing enforces. Roll back per the Implementation Guide (set DLP back to Test/disable, remove the label policy, unpublish the retention label). .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). High-impact: labels/DLP/retention are piloted in simulation/test first. Retention periods, FERPA applicability, and holds are records/legal determinations supplied by you, not invented here. Verify cmdlet/plan availability for your tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][ValidateSet('Labels','DLP','Retention')][string]$Area,

How to run: Labels (preview then commit): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Labels -WhatIf .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Labels -Commit FERPA DLP policy IN TEST (references the 'EDU - Student ID' SIT / 'EDU - Student Record (FERPA)' label): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area DLP -WhatIf Student-record retention label (period from the records owner — REQUIRED, no default): .\EDU-Set-Configuration.ps1 -Area Retention -RetentionYears 5 -Commit Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin. EXPECTED RESULTS -WhatIf prints each intended create with no change. -Commit performs it and re-reads the object. PASS = objects exist as intended, DLP in Test. Nothing enforces. Roll back per the Implementation Guide (set DLP back to Test/disable, remove the label policy, unpublish the retention label). .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). High-impact: labels/DLP/retention are piloted in simulation/test first. Retention periods, FERPA applicability, and holds are records/legal determinations supplied by you, not invented here. Verify cmdlet/plan availability for your tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][ValidateSet('Labels','DLP','Retention')][string]$Area,

EDU-Validation.ps1

Purpose: Scores the education program with no changes: the FERPA DLP policy exists and is in TEST (flags any policy that is ENFORCING), the label policy targets the pilot, the student-record retention label exists with a non-zero approved period, and the DLP rule references the education-record signal (the 'EDU - Student ID' SIT and/or the 'EDU - Student Record (FERPA)' label). Emits a PASS/FAIL per gate mirroring the Testing Guide. Read-only. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Validation.ps1 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin; no secrets. Override the checked names with -DlpName / -RetentionLabel / -LabelPolicy if you renamed. EXPECTED RESULTS A scorecard: each gate GREEN (pass) or RED (fail) with a remediation pointer. PASS overall = every in-scope gate green for the pilot AND no DLP policy enforcing before sign-off. Adequacy of the retention period / FERPA scope is NOT scored — that is records/legal's. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Proves the technical controls are present and SAFE (DLP not enforcing); does not certify FERPA compliance. Verify cmdlet/plan names for your tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$DlpName = 'EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot', [string]$RetentionLabel = 'EDU - Student Education Record', [string]$LabelPolicy = 'EDU - Label Policy - Pilot', [string]$StudentIdSit = 'EDU - Student ID', [string]$RecordLabel = 'EDU - Student Record (FERPA)')

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\EDU-Validation.ps1 Requires ExchangeOnlineManagement (Connect-IPPSSession). Interactive modern-auth / MFA admin; no secrets. Override the checked names with -DlpName / -RetentionLabel / -LabelPolicy if you renamed. EXPECTED RESULTS A scorecard: each gate GREEN (pass) or RED (fail) with a remediation pointer. PASS overall = every in-scope gate green for the pilot AND no DLP policy enforcing before sign-off. Adequacy of the retention period / FERPA scope is NOT scored — that is records/legal's. .NOTES Purview category — Microsoft Purview for Education (FERPA). Read-only. Proves the technical controls are present and SAFE (DLP not enforcing); does not certify FERPA compliance. Verify cmdlet/plan names for your tenant. > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$DlpName = 'EDU - FERPA Student Records - DLP - Pilot', [string]$RetentionLabel = 'EDU - Student Education Record', [string]$LabelPolicy = 'EDU - Label Policy - Pilot', [string]$StudentIdSit = 'EDU - Student ID', [string]$RecordLabel = 'EDU - Student Record (FERPA)')